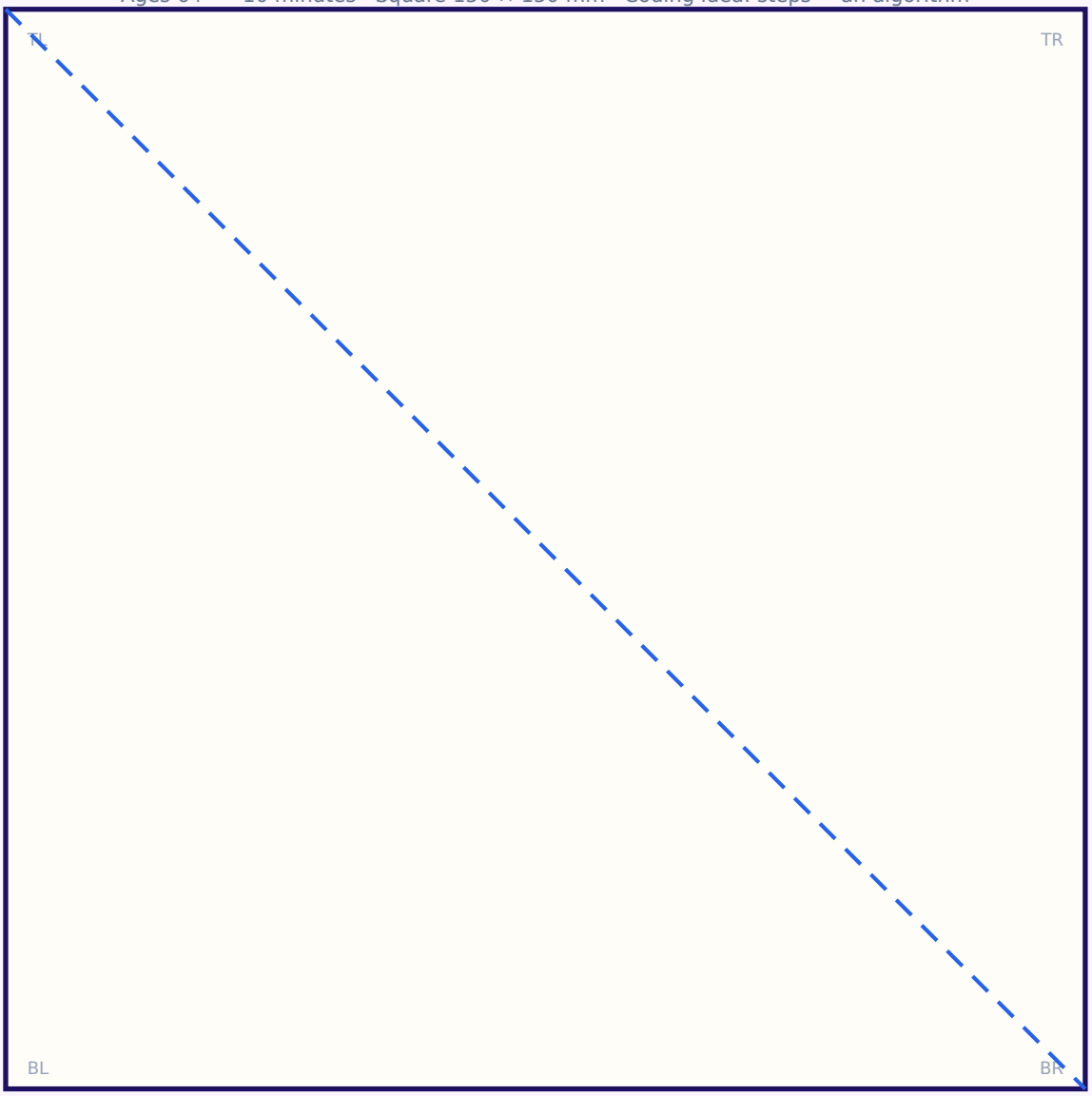
Fold a Paper Cup

Ages 6+ · ~10 minutes · Square 150 × 150 mm · Coding idea: steps = an algorithm

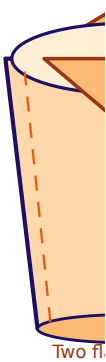
True-size square 150 × 150 mm (cut from A4 if needed)



Cut on the solid outer edge if your paper is not already square. Blue dashed = first valley crease (fold toward you).

150 mm

Fini



Two fl

Symbol key

Valley (fold toward you)

Mountain (fold away)

↻ Turn over → Fold arrow ✓ Check silhouette ★ Finished cup

You need

- 1 square paper 150 mm
- Clean hands · Flat table
- Optional: cup of water to test!

Coding / maths link

An algorithm is a list of steps in order. Skip a fold and the cup fails — just like a bug!

100 mm

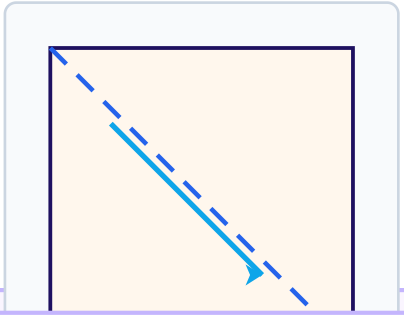
20 mm

Measure this bar. It must be exactly 100 mm. PRINT AT 100% / ACTUAL SIZE — do NOT "fit to page".

Origami for Kids · Project #01 · Paper Cup · Steps 1–7 · page 2/2 (1:1 scale)

PRINT AT 100% / ACTUAL SIZE

1 Diagonal valley

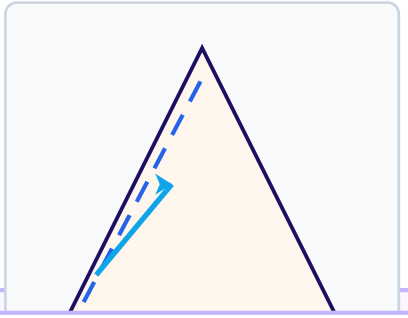


DO
Fold TL corner to BR.

CHECK ✓
A triangle.

TIP
Crease with a fingernail.

2 Left corner up

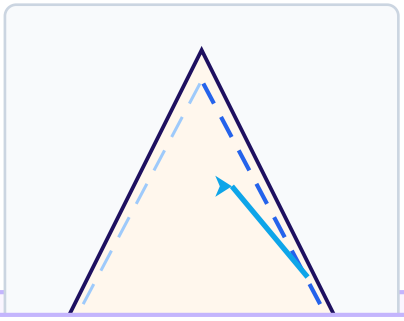


DO
Fold left tip to the top.

CHECK ✓
Left flap meets the peak.

TIP
Keep the triangle stacked.

3 Right corner up

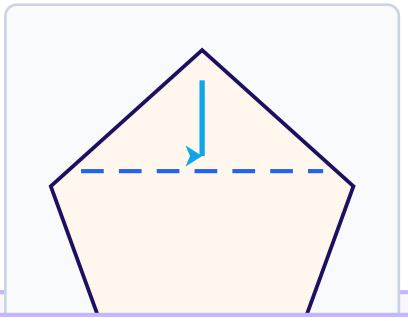


DO
Fold right tip to the top.

CHECK ✓
Both sides match (symmetry

TIP
Mirror the left fold.

4 Front lip down

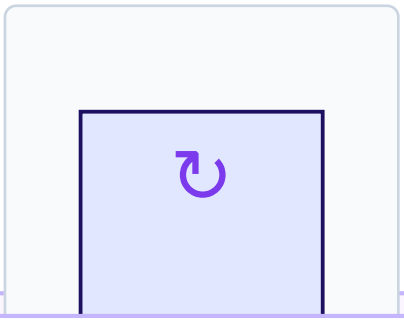


DO
Fold the front peak into the poc

CHECK ✓
Front lip tucked.

TIP
Slide into the little pocket.

5 Turn over

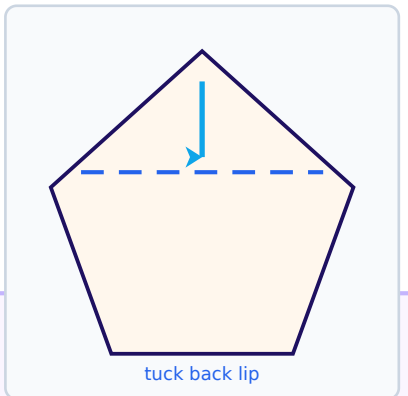


DO
Flip the whole model.

CHECK ✓
Back looks like the front did

TIP
Like flipping a pancake.

6 Back lip down

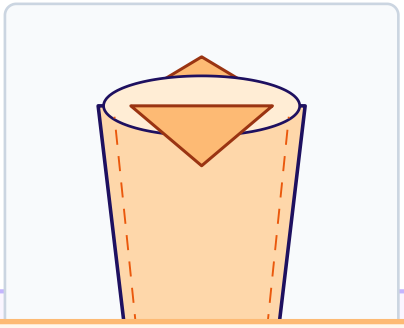


DO
Tuck the back peak the same w

CHECK ✓
Both lips locked.

TIP
Same move as step 4.

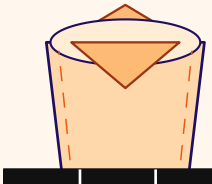
7 Open the cup



DO
Squeeze sides, push the bottom flat.

CHECK ✓
A 3D cup!

TIP
Gentle — do not tear.



Finished! — Your paper should look like this

Flat closed cup (both lips tucked) → open 3D cup with a flat bottom.

If a lip slips out, redo steps 4–6. Try-it: fold a second cup from a magazine page.

still w





Measure this bar. It must be exactly 100 mm. PRINT AT 100% / ACTUAL SIZE — do NOT "fit to page".